SMS NEWSLETTER
QUARTERLY CHRONICLE
BY SMS RESEARCH FORUM

MESSAGE FROM DEAN OF SOCIAL SCIENCES, CUSAT



Prof.Dr. D.MAVOOTHU

Dean, Faculty of Social Sciences, CUSAT & Vice Chancellor, Mahatma Gandhi University, Kottayam, Kerala

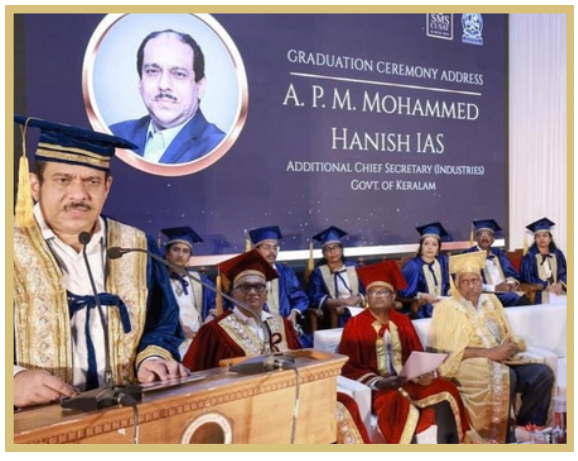
Behind every researcher lies a world that extends far beyond papers, presentations, data, and deadlines. It is a world shaped by curiosity, ideas waiting to be explored, milestones worth celebrating, talents being nurtured, and creative pursuits that find expression in many forms.

This edition of the SMS Research Forum Newsletter seeks to bring these dimensions together.It celebrates not only the scholarly journeys of our researchers, but also the creativity, imagination, and individuality that enrich our research community. Each achievement reflects a commitment to inquiry and excellence, while every creative expression reminds us that research is ultimately driven by people - their perspectives, passions & aspirations.

As a Business School as part of CUSAT, we believe that a vibrant research culture is one that recognises and nurtures the researcher as a whole. By creating space for both intellectual contributions and creative ex-pression, we hope to build a community where ideas flourish, achievements are shared, and individuals feel encouraged to ex-plore their diverse potential. I am delighted to present this edition as a cele-bration of progress, purpose, and creativity within our research community.

May it inspire us to look beyond con-ventional boundaries, appreciate the many dimensions of our colleagues, and continue to foster a research culture grounded in curiosity, collaboration, and human con-nection.

EVENTS AT SMS





Graduation Ceremony 2026
19 September 2026

The School of Management Studies, CUSAT, celebrated its Graduation Ceremony 2026, commemorating the academic achievements and accomplishments of its graduating students.

Prof. (Dr.) Sam Thomas, Director of SMS, delivered the welcome address, followed by the convocation address from A. P. M. Mohammed Hanish, IAS, Additional Chief Secretary (Industries), Government of Kerala. The presidential address was delivered by Sr. Prof. (Dr.) M. Junaid Bushiri, Vice-Chancellor, CUSAT, while Mr. Prasad K. Panicker, Executive Chairman, Nayara Energy Limited, graced the occasion as Guest of Honour with a special address. Prof. (Dr.) D. Mavoothu, Vice-Chancellor, MG University and Dean, Faculty of Social Sciences, CUSAT has presented the graduates. Dr. Harigovind P.C., Registrar, CUSAT; Mr. Algiers Khalid, President, KMA; and Prof. (Dr.) Manoj N., Controller of Examinations, CUSAT felicitated the program. Vote of Thanks was delivered by Prof. (Dr.) Santhosh Kumar. S, SMS, CUSAT.

The event witnessed the formal release of the Placement Brochure 2026, marking a significant milestone in the students' academic journey and the beginning of a new chapter ahead.



MBA Induction Programme 2026

20 July 2026

The School of Management Studies, CUSAT, inaugurated its MBA Induction Programme 2026 at the SMS Auditorium, welcoming the new MBA cohort. The programme was inaugurated by Prof. (Dr.) M. Junaid Bushiri, Vice Chancellor, CUSAT, and presided over by Prof. (Dr.) Sam Thomas, Director, SMS. Mr. Bijimon K. R., Executive Director & COO, Muthoot Finance Ltd., delivered the keynote address. The programme also featured addresses by Prof. (Dr.) D. Mavoothu, Dr. Manu Melwin Joy, and Dr. Nimitha Aboobaker.



Expert session by Dr. Veena Mani, The Indian Dissertation Coach

7 September 2026

SMS Research forum successfully organised an insightful expert session on “What Proposal Reviewers Looks For” . The session commenced with a warm welcome address by Dr. Devi Soumyaja, Assistant Professor & Research Coordinator, SMS, CUSAT followed bv an introduction of expert by Ms. Lakshmi G, Research Scholar & Coordinator, SMS Research Forum. The Vote of Thanks was delivered by Ms Hasnath Hameedh.
The session provided participants with practical guidance and perspectives to strengthen their journey



Dr. Ramesh Babu S Memorial Award - Best Outgoing Student of MBA Full -Time Batch 2024-2026

9 September 2026

The programme was graced by Mr. Elias George, Chairman of Federal Bank and former IAS officer, as the Keynote Speaker and Guest of Honour.
The event was inaugurated by Sr. Prof. Dr. M. Junaid Bushiri, the Vice Chancellor, CUSAT, and the event was also attended by Mr. Philip K. P. representing the SMS 80 Foundation, along with the Director, School of Management Studies, faculty members, students and other distinguished guests.
The Dr. Ramesh Babu S. Memorial Award for the Best Outgoing Student Award was conferred upon Ms. Irene Elsa George and Ms. Sneha K. S.



Research Scholars’ Trip

23 July 2026

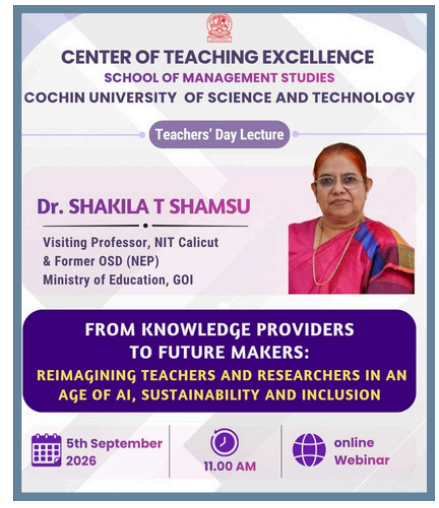
SMS Research forum celebrates the success of ‘International Conference and Colloqiuim 2026’ by taking a pause from research, running together to ‘Whispering waters’ at Paniyeli Poru, filled with games, pool, laughter, conversations and moments to remember.



SMS Onam 2K26

20 August 2026

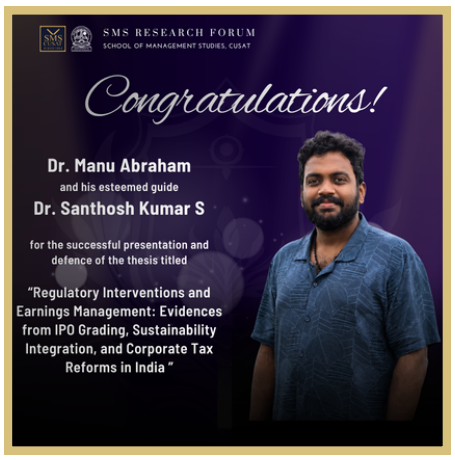
SMS scholars came together with MBA students to celebrate the vibrant spirit of Onam 2026. The celebration featured exciting games, cultural programmes, and the traditional Pookalam, filling the campus with joy and festive spirit. Onam 2026 at SMS was truly a memorable and joyful celebration of togetherness.



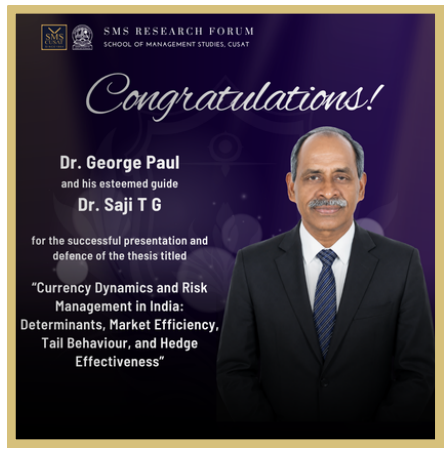
Teacher’s Day Lecture

5 September 2026

OPEN DEFENCES









RESEARCH RELATED NEWS

The DAAD (German Academic Exchange Service) PhD scholarship applications for the 2027 intake are currently open

DAAD, the world's largest funder of international academic exchange, and its Research Grants ,opens applications for Indian students, featuring updated stipend amounts and clear submission timelines. Applications close ***21 October 2026***, the selection committee meets around February 2027, and funding starts in October 2027.

The Missing Link In Social Science Research in India

India's doctoral research ecosystem in social sciences is in urgent need of a structural overhaul. While doctoral scholars in other countries are evaluated on working prototypes and real world applications ,the Indian system remains weeded to voluminous dissertations and pressure to publish in so called peer reviewed or indexed journals.The missing link between academia and society must be not only established but made mandatory in every university. Only then will India's doctoral degrees reflect the rigor and relevance that the nations investments in higher education demands.

ALUMNI CORNER



Executive MBA Inauguration 2026

The MBA Executive Batch 2026 officially embarked on a new academic journey with an inspiring inaugural address by ***Mr. Manoj K. P., Co-Founder, Director & CEO, ThinkPalm Technologies Pvt. Ltd.*** Mr.Manoj belongs to 1998-2000 MBA FT batch. The inaugural ceremony was conducted on 23rd September 2026.





Rendezvous with Legacy Leaders | SMS Alumni Talk Series

The School of Management Studies, CUSAT, hosted Rendezvous with Legacy Leaders as part of the SMS Alumni Talk Series, featuring ***K. V. Abdul Azeez, Founder, Chairman and Managing Director of Skyline Builders*** on 25 September 2026.

The session offered students valuable insights into leadership, entrepreneurship, and the business world, drawing from his professional journey and experiences.

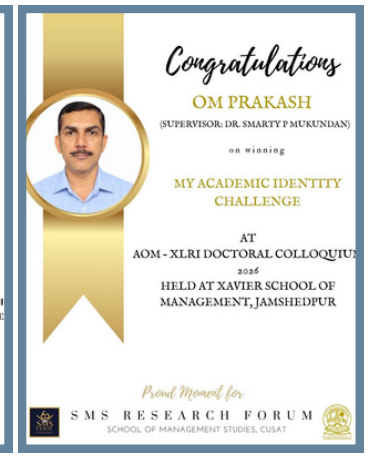
The interaction provided a meaningful platform for learning and engagement between industry experience and the academic community.

Mr.K. V. Abdul Azeez belongs to 1976-1978 of MBA FT Batch.

BEST PAPER AWARDS





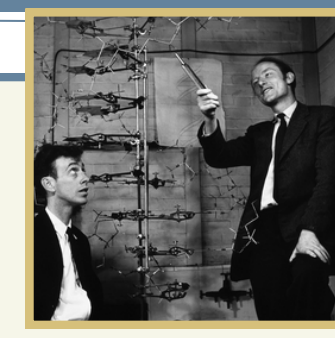


PUBLISHED ARTICLES





DID YOU KNOW?



Watson & Crick's Nobel-Winning Paper Was Never Refereed

The 1953 Nature paper by **James Watson and Francis Crick** detailing the double-helix structure of DNA—one of the most impactful discoveries in human history—was published without any formal peer review.

The journal's editor, John Maddox, skipped the referee process entirely because the structure's correctness was deemed "self-evident." Furthermore, editors feared that if they sent the paper to a rival expert (like Linus Pauling), the groundbreaking secret would instantly leak before publication

CREATIVE CORNER

ത്രേസ്യാമ്മച്ചി

തൻറെ ശരീരം ഈ നാടിന് അന്യമായി തീർന്നിരിക്കുന്നു.
എന്തൊരു ചൂട്!...
കാനഡയിൽ നിന്ന് ഫ്ലൈറ്റ്പിടിച്ച് ഇവിടെ എത്തിയപ്പോൾ മുതൽ തുടങ്ങിയതാണ് ഈ ചൂടിനോടുള്ള യുദ്ധം. ഉരുകി ഉരുകി ആത്മാവ് ഒലിച്ചുപോകാറായി. അപ്പോഴാണ് ടാക്സി കാറിന്റെ പാട്ടുപെട്ടിയിൽ നിന്ന് ആ ഗാനം ഉയർന്നത്...
ആത്മാവേ പോ..... ഓ...ഓ..ഓ...ഓ...ഓ..ഓ..ഓ.
"ഇത് ഏത് സിനിമയിലെ പാട്ടാ ചേട്ടാ?"
ഇളയ സന്തതി ടോണിക്കുട്ടൻ ഡ്രൈവറോട് ചോദിച്ചു.
"ഇത് രോമാഞ്ചത്തിലെയാ... പുതിയ പടാ... നല്ല കളക്ഷൻ ഉണ്ടല്ലോ...നിങ്ങൾ കണ്ടിട്ടില്ലേ?"
"ഇല്ല."
ഇതുപോലൊരു പാട്ട് ഇറക്കിവിടുന്നവനെ പറഞ്ഞാൽ മതി! ഓരോ തവണയും ആ പാട്ട് എന്റെ ആത്മാവിനോട് പോകാൻ ആഹ്വാനം ചെയ്യുമ്പോഴും, മിന്നാരം സിനിമയിലെ വാതിൽക്കൊളുത്തിൽ അള്ളിപ്പിടിച്ചിരിക്കുന്ന കുതിരവട്ടം പപ്പുവിനെപ്പോലെ ആയിരുന്നു എന്റെ മനസ്സ്.
'പോവുലടാ പട്ടി' എന്ന് പറയാതെ പറഞ്ഞു കാണണം.
അങ്ങനെ ചൂടിനോടും പാട്ടിനോടും യുദ്ധം ചെയ്ത് ഒരു വിധം വീട്ടിലെത്തി.

Continue reading by scanning the QR

"Thresyammachi" - short story by Gavin John



"Warmth Beaneath The Hail"
Painting by Khadeeja Noushad

CALL FOR PAPERS

Reimagining Accounting for Inclusive Capitalism

This Special Issue invites contributions that critically and constructively examine how accounting may contribute to reimagining capitalism for a more inclusive future on **Accounting, Auditing & Accountability Journal**

Deadline: 1st November 2026

Green HRM in the Global South: Establishing Sustainability, Responsible Transformations, ano Resilient Organizational Development

This special issue addresses GHRM practices in the Global South. It welcomes conceptual papers, empirical research and case studies from regions located in the Global South. on **International Journal of Organizational Analysis.**

Deadline: 30th November 2026

Call for critical reflection papers

As one of the leading journals in our field, IJCHM communicates the latest developments and thinking on management of hospitality and tourism businesses worldwide on **International Journal of Contemporary Hospitality Management.**

Deadline : 31st December 2027

Meaning, Meaningfulness, & purpose at work:Towards conceptual clarity & integration

on the Journal **Career Development International.**

Deadline: 1st March 2027

ACHIEVEMENTS





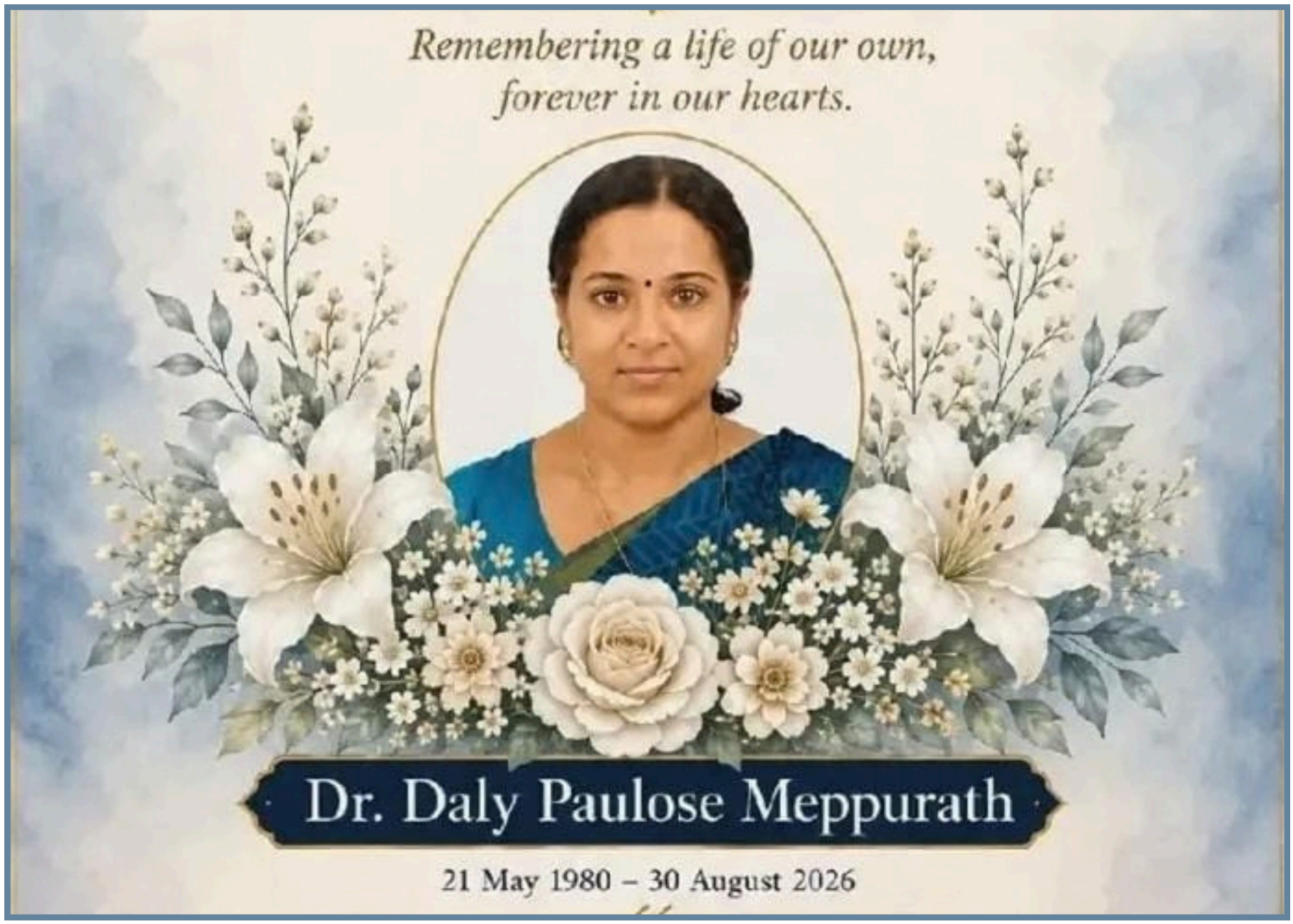








IN MEMORIAM



We deeply mourn the passing of **Dr. Daly Paulose Meppurath**, Assistant Professor at the School of Management Studies, Cochin University of Science and Technology (CUSAT), whose presence, contributions, and association with our academic community will always be remembered.

We extend our heartfelt condolences to her family, colleagues, and loved ones. May her soul rest in peace.